C. Luke Watson

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Research Interests

Housing Markets, Bank Competition, Public Economics, Urban Economics, Industrial Organization

Employment

Senior Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC — Aug 2023
Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC — Aug 2021 - Aug 2023

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University — 2015 - 2021
M.A. Economics, Old Dominion University — 2013 - 2015
B.A. Economics, Old Dominion University — 2009 - 2013

Publications

"Is the Rent Too High: Land Ownership and Monopoly Power" (with O.Ziv) — 2026
– Forthcoming, **Real Estate Economics**; Pre-publication PDF

"A Test for Pricing Power in Urban Housing Markets" (with O.Ziv) — 2025
– Accepted, **Review of Economics and Statistics**; Pre-publication PDF

Working Papers

"Is the NIT Better Than the EITC? Targeted Transfers in General Equilibrium" (Solo) — 2026
"When Does Market Definition Matter for Identification?" (Solo) — 2026
"Bank Competition for Neighborhood Deposits" (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner) — 2026

Selected Works in Progress

"Measuring Local Liquid Savings" (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner)
"A Test for Collusion in Housing Markets Using Algorithmic Pricing" (with A.Handler, C.Spaenjers, & O.Ziv)
"Estimating Markups using Pass-Through Regressions" (with O.Ziv)

Prior Employment

Instructor : Development Economics (Michigan State University) — Fall 2020
Instructor : Principles of Microeconomics (Old Dominion University) — Summer 2015
TA : (MSU) Public Revenues, Ec. of Poverty & Income, Int'l Trade (x4), Urban Econ (x3) Interm.Micro, Intro.Micro, Intro.Macro — 2015-2020
TA : (AEASP) Foundations Microeconomics and Mathematics — Summer 2017
RA : (MSU) Oren Ziv, Prabhat Barnwal — 2016-2020
RA : (ODU) Gary Wagner, Tim Komarek — 2013-2015

Presentations

2027: AEA / ASSA.
2026: NTA, DC Finance Day, Society of Government Economists, FDIC Consumer Finance Round Robin.
2025: Richmond Fed, AREUEA Nat'l, NYC DOF, DC Urban Day.
2024: Lincoln Institute UE & PE Conference. 2023: Mid-Atlantic Trade Workshop, NTA.
2022: AREUEA / ASSA, AREUEA Nat'l, NTA, UEA (USA). 2021: UEA (Europe).
2020: Ohio University, MVEA, NTA. 2019: NTA.

FDIC Projects

Data: DIR Deposits Insurance Estimates [Internal]	2026
Memo: DI Limits Increases [Internal]	2025
Deposit Study: GFC Runs [Internal]	2025
Options for Deposit Insurance Reform [Public]	2023
Literature Review on Digital Currencies and Financial Stability [Internal]	2022
Crypto-Watch Paper Round-Up [Internal]	2022-2025

Dissertation Work on EITC

"The General Equilibrium Incidence of the Earned Income Tax Credit"	2021
"Estimating Supply & Demand Elasticities Using a Single Tax Rate with GE Spillovers"	2021
"The Local Labor Market Effects of State EITC Supplements"	2021

Service

FDIC - Reader for FDIC Bank Research Conference	2026
FDIC - History of the FDIC presenter	2024–2026
AEASP-FDIC - Experiential Learning Partner	Summer 2024
FDIC - CFR Seminar Coordinator	2022-2024
FDIC - Reader for FDIC Consumer Research Symposium	2022-2023
Michigan State University - Graduate Student Workshop Organizer	2017-2020

Referee Service

Contemporary Economic Policy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Public Finance Review, Quarterly Review of Economics and Finance, Regional Science and Urban Economics

Awards and Grants

Mission Achievement Award (FDIC)	2023,2025,2026
Star Award (FDIC)	2022,2024,2025
Dissertation Completion Fellowship (MSU)	2020
Outstanding Graduate Economics Student Award (ODU)	2015
Graduate Student Tuition Fellowship (ODU)	2013-2015
Constant Dominion Business Student Merit Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Town-N-Gown Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Governor's Technology Tuition Scholarship (ODU)	2009-2013

Memberships

American Economics Assoc., American Real Estate & Urban Economics Assoc., National Tax Assoc.